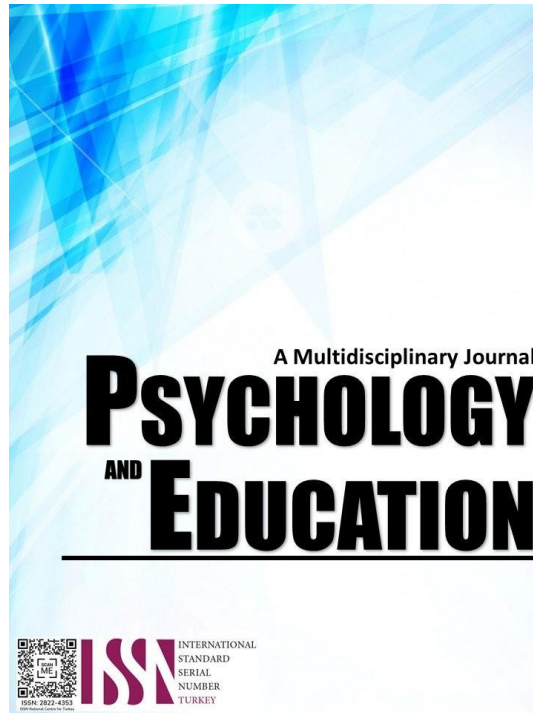


STRAND AND STATEHOOD OF SENIOR HIGH SCHOOL – TECHNICAL VOCATIONAL LIVELIHOOD GRADUATES OF A PUBLIC SENIOR HIGH SCHOOL



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Strand and Statehood of Senior High School – Technical Vocational Livelihood Graduates of a Public Senior High School

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Abstract

Seven years after the implementation of the K to 12 curriculum in the Philippines' basic education system, which added two years of senior high school, students are now offered four curriculum exits: higher education, middle-level work, entrepreneurship, and employment. However, previous research revealed that despite the rationale of the K-12 program that promises job-ready and entrepreneurial skills after graduation, more Filipinos preferred a college diploma over immediate employment. With this, the study traced the statehood of senior high school–technical vocational livelihood (TVL) graduates of Lambayong National High School across seven batches. It also assessed whether their current pursuits aligned with their chosen TVL strands. The research design was descriptive survey research design, which was employed using validated survey questionnaires on one thousand and two respondents, wherein frequency and percentage were utilized. Findings revealed that fifty-one percent of the graduates pursued higher education, eleven percent were in professional employment, twenty-one percent engaged in middle-skill jobs, and four percent ventured into entrepreneurship, while thirteen percent were unemployed. Moreover, the overall alignment between their taken SHS strands and their statehood was seventy-two percent. The results suggest that TVL graduates value higher education to enhance skills learned in SHS, aiming for better career opportunities both locally and abroad. Moreover, the study highlights the importance of alignment between SHS-TVL strands and graduates' post-secondary paths, demonstrating the TVL track's relevance in preparing students for future endeavors. Furthermore, statistical analysis confirmed that the graduates' socio-economic profiles significantly influenced their strand selection. These insights informed the development of a policy brief aimed at enhancing the implementation and effectiveness of the TVL track in the Senior High School program.

Keywords: *K to 12 curriculum, technical-vocational livelihood, strand alignment, tracer study, senior high school, TVL graduates, socio-economic profile*

Introduction

Basic education in the Philippines has undergone different changes throughout the years, and amongst these was Republic Act 10533's ratification also known as "Enhanced Basic Education Act of 2013," which allowed the Department of Education to undertake its major and boldest education reform in history (DepEd Order No. 21, s. 2., 2019). The act augmented the Philippines' basic education, notably at the secondary level, with two more years known as the senior high school. In the K–12 curriculum, four exits are included to give graduates the choice of pursuing higher education, middle-level work, entrepreneurship, or employment.

Notwithstanding the substantial efforts made by Philippine government to augment the system of basic education by means of K to 12 curriculum which initially aims to produce senior high school graduates who are prepared for employment, SHS graduates struggles with employability. In the study unveiled only 20% of the 70 top corporations in the nation are willing to employ SHS graduates, despite the fact that the first batch of graduates supposedly has 93% of the competencies favoring individuals with at least two years of college education or recent graduates (Llego, 2021; PIDS, 2020). Moreover, in the tracer study of Bureau of Curriculum Development (BCD) 2019 and 2020 showed that while 10.22% of the graduates found work, the bulk (82.67%) continued their study. Just a small portion developed middle-level skills (0.42%) and started their own business (1.30%). After graduating from SHS, 5.39 percent of the graduates choose not to pursue any of the exits. This implies that in contrary to the argument of K to 12 programs of employability and entrepreneurship, a significant number of SHS graduates studying higher education believing that college diploma will assure them a greater future than having Senior high school diploma alone.

Lambayong National High School, a public secondary high school in the province of Sultan Kudarat, offered program for senior high school to respond with the DepEd's K to 12 curriculum. It offered two tracks: Academic and the TVL Track. Humanities and Social Sciences (HUMSS) and Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics (STEM) are the strands offered in the Academic. The strands under the track of TVL includes Information and Communication Technology (ICT), Industrial Arts (IA), and Home Economics (HE), respectively. Ever since the K to 12 program was implemented, it produced SHS graduates already. Tracing the statehood of the school's graduates serves as an effort to confirm that the program has served its objective in meeting the requirement to produce employment-ready and perpetually learning individuals (Padios, et al., 2021).

Tracing the statehood of the TVL graduates and its alignment to their taken strands to further determine the efficacy of the Technical Vocational Track as they were taught and trained with the essential ready for employment and entrepreneurship. Hence, this tracer study provided information for the school, the division and other policy-making organizations about how the program have been performing. Doing tracer studies is important in acknowledging and solving issues related to curriculum, graduates' unemployment reasons, the

status of the employment and job search timeframe as emphasized by Albina & Sumagaysay (2020).

Although, there were several tracer studies concerning the Senior High School graduates in the national level as mentioned above, there is no existing tracer study conducted yet in the Lambayong National High School. Furthermore, studies about TVL strands and statehood still part of the research gap and no existing study to evaluate the alignment of the strand chosen by the TVL graduates. This was the thrust the study had, to track the TVL Senior High School graduates' strands and statehood, specifically in Lambayong National High School, Lambayong Municipality in province of Sultan Kudarat.

Research Questions

This study aimed to determine the statehood of the Senior High School – Technical Vocational Livelihood graduates of Lambayong National High School, Batches 2018 to 2024. This also investigated the alignment of their taken strand and their statehood. Specifically, this study answered the following questions:

1. What is the economic profile of the Senior High School – Technical Vocational Livelihood graduates in terms of:
 - 1.1 age;
 - 1.2 gender;
 - 1.3 civil status;
 - 1.4 highest educational attainment; and
 - 1.5 family monthly income?
2. What is the strand taken by the Senior High School – Technical Vocational Livelihood graduates?
3. What is the statehood of the Senior High School – Technical Vocational Livelihood graduates in terms of:
 - 3.1 higher education;
 - 3.2 employment;
 - 3.3 middle-level skill development;
 - 3.4 entrepreneurship; and
 - 3.5 unemployment?
4. What is the percentage of alignment between the Senior High School – Technical Vocational Livelihood graduates chosen strands and their statehood?
5. Is there a significant influence between the Senior High School – Technical Vocational Livelihood graduates' economic profile and their taken TVL strand?
6. What policy brief can be developed?

Methodology

Research Design

The study was quantitative in nature and employed descriptive-correlational research design to determine the strand and statehood of the SHS-TVL graduates, the alignment of their taken strand and to their statehood and the influence of socio-economic profile of the graduates to their taken strand.

Descriptive research, as ascertained by Accad and Accad (2016), reveals the characteristics of the society, individuals, institution or group of individuals. This is in conformity with the study of Sirisilla (2023) which states that it is a strong instrument used by researchers in collecting data about phenomenon. A comprehensive and accurate picture of the features and actions of a particular population or subject will be taken from this research. According to Bhat (2023), descriptive correlational research is regarded as a type of research design that tries to explain the relationship between two or more variables without making any claims about cause and effect. It includes collecting and analyzing data on at least two variables to see if there is a link between them.

In the context of this study, descriptive research design was utilized in describing the socio-demographic profile of the graduates, strand taken, graduates' statehood and the alignment of the taken strand and statehood of the graduates.

Correlational research, according to Stangor (2014), is research designed to discover relationships among variables and to allow the prediction of future events from present knowledge. The direction of a correlation can be either positive or negative. Similarly, Bhandari (2023) asserts that correlational research is ideal for gathering data quickly from natural settings and helps in generalizing findings to real-life situations in an externally valid way. Further, correlational research can provide initial indications or additional support for theories about causal relationships. Correlational research may provide insights into complex real-world relationship, helping researchers develop theories and make predictions.

As shown in the following definitions, the correlational research as research design is suitable to describe the influence of the socio-economic profile of the graduates in taking their strand.

Respondents

All SHS-TVL graduates of Lambayong National High School batch 2018-2024 was expected to join in the study. But, a total of 1002

out of 1519 were located, supplying the study with 66% response rate. It did not reach the 100% response as the researcher respect for the respondents' autonomy in deciding whether to participate and to skip questions they find uncomfortable.

The researcher employed total enumeration in determining respondents. Thus, all SHS TVL graduates based on the Learning Information System were subjected to be respondents but only a total of 1002 out of 1519 contacted, giving the study with 66% response rate. Also, snowball sampling was utilized. Graduates who were contacted and answered the survey were asked about the whereabouts of the other SHS-TVL graduates for their contact details. The information given was used to locate and find other respondents to collect the needed research data.

Instrument

Descriptive Survey questionnaires and SF 5 or the Report on Promotion and Learning Progress and Achievement for batch 2018-2024 were the research instruments of the study.

The descriptive survey questionnaire adapted to Padios, et al. (2021). The questionnaire was both printed and sent through google form will consist of 3 parts. Part 1 focused on the respondents' socio-demographic profile composed of age, sex, and monthly family income (MFI). Part 2 concentrated on the curricular profile of the respondents and Part 3 concerns on the statehood of the SHS-TVL graduates.

To identify the names and population of SHS-TVL for school year 2018-2024, Report on Promotion and Learning Progress and Achievement (SF5) was utilized.

Procedure

The researcher sought permission from the Graduate School before the survey was administered. Also, letters of request for the Schools Division Superintendent of the Division of Sultan Kudarat and for the principal of Lambayong National High School. were sent before the conduct the study.

After the permission was approved from the authorities, the researcher requested the validators to validate the survey questionnaire. When the validation was done, the researcher administered the survey through paper and pen and through online using the Google form link to the respondents. After, the answered questionnaire was retrieved and data were encoded, computed, analyzed and interpreted.

Data Analysis

Statistical treatment employed to answer the research problems were:

Frequency count and percentage were utilized that answered SOP 1, graduates' socio-economic profile; SOP 2, their taken strand; SOP 3, their current statehood and SOP 4, the alignment of their taken strand and statehood.

Pearson chi-square test of independence was used to answer SOP 5 and to verify hypothesis that if there is a significant influence of the graduates' socio-economic profile to their taken strand. Wuensch (2011) defined that Pearson Chi-Square test is a statistical method used to determine whether there is a significant association between categorical variables. It is commonly applied in research to assess relationships between observed and expected frequencies. Testing Independence is used to evaluate whether two categorical variables are related. For example, determining if socio-economic status influences strand selection in senior high school.

Ethical Considerations

The respondents were given informed consent, and they were fully aware of the study's purpose, procedures, and potential risks before participating. They must voluntarily agree to take part without coercion. The respondents were given certificate and simple token as form of acknowledgement and appreciation with contribution to Institutional Growth. Their input helps shape policies and program enhancements that not only benefit future students but also strengthen the reputation of their alma mater, which can indirectly boost their credentials.

Results and Discussion

Socio-economic profile of the SHS-TVL graduates in terms of Age, Gender, Civil Status, Highest Educational Attainment, and Family Monthly Income

The socio-economic profile such gender, civil status, highest educational attainment, and family monthly income of the TVL-Senior High School graduates from 2018 - 2024 were gathered to answer the first research question. The figures that follow illustrate the frequency count and percentage distribution of defined categories.

Figure 1 shows the socio-economic profile of the SHS-TVL graduates concerning their age. It can be gleaned that 778 (77.60%) which is majority of the graduates from year 2018 to 2023 were 20-25 years old, only 94 (9.40%) were 26 to 30 years old whereas batch 2024 age ranges to below 20 were 130 (13%), younger than the previous batches because they recently graduated from senior high school. The graduates' age range falls within the array that is recommended for their particular educational level according to UNESCO Institute of Statistics (2020).

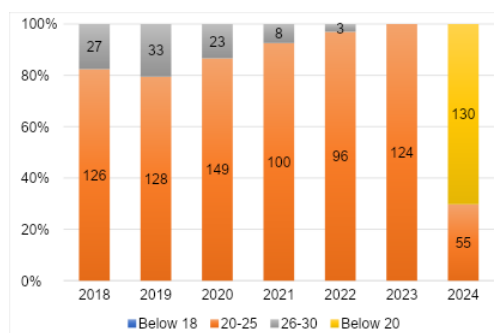


Figure 1. Socio-economic Profile of the SHS-TVL Graduates in terms of Age

Figure 2 illustrates the socio-economic profile of the SHS-TVL graduates with regards to gender. Male respondents were 428 (43%) while female was 574 (57%) completing the total respondents 1002 (100%) Data reveal that responses gathered many came from female graduates than male graduate similar to the findings of Padios et al (2021), Febrer et al (2022) and Dela Cruz (2023) as opposed to the national situation where female have consistently outperformed men in terms of completing education.

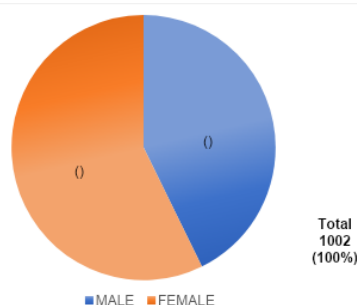


Figure 2. Socio-economic Profile of the SHS-TVL Graduates in terms of Gender

Figure 3 presents the socio-economic profile of the SHS-TVL graduates regarding civil status. At the time of the survey, majority of the graduates from the total sample across the seven batches were single, with the frequency count sum of 776 (77.45%) while only 226 (22.55%) was married. This is similar to Padios et al (2021) and Febrer et al (2022) which majority their respondents were single.

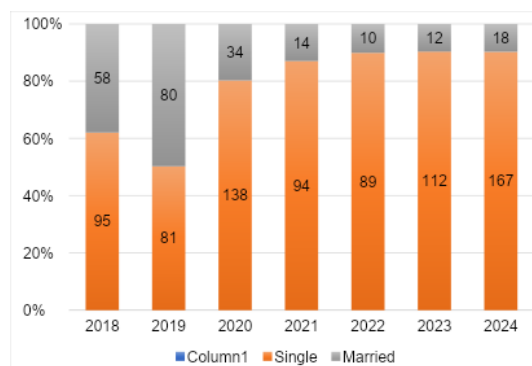


Figure 3. Socio-economic Profile of the SHS-TVL Graduates in terms of Civil Status

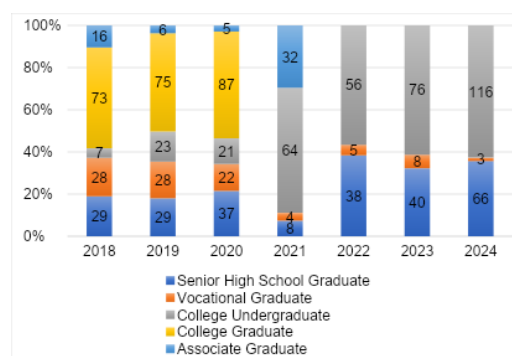


Figure 4. Socio-economic Profile of the SHS-TVL Graduates in terms of Highest Educational Attainment

Figure 4 indicates the socio-economic profile of the SHS-TVL graduates focusing on their highest educational attainment. Almost half of the senior high school graduates from 2018 to 2020 were college graduate already evidently supported with their frequency count and percentage, 73 (47.70%) for year 2018; 75 (46.58%) for 2019; 87 (50.60%) for 2020, respectively.

Contrary to the graduates from year 2021 to 2024 which most of them are still college undergraduate with the data of 64 (59.30%) for 2021; 56 (56.56%) for the year 2022; 76 (61.29%) for the year 2023 and 116 (62.70%) for the year 2024.

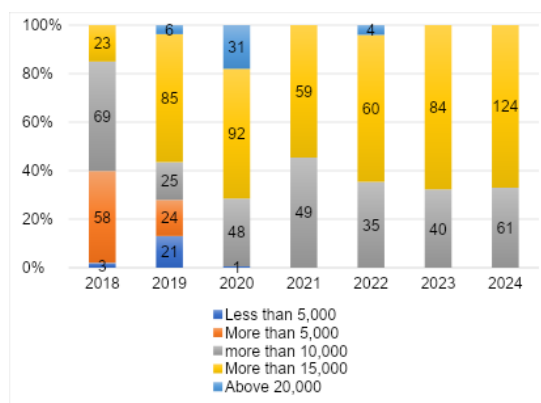


Figure 5. Socio-economic Profile of the SHS-TVL Graduates in terms of Monthly Family Income

Figure 5 describes the socio-economic profile of the SHS-TVL graduates focusing on their monthly family income. Data showed that 527 which is half (52.48%) of the graduates from 2018 to 2024 have more than 15,000 monthly family income whereas only 41 (4.01%) earned monthly family income of above 20,000.

This implies that the SHS-TVL graduates belongs to low income (but not poor) according to the Philippine Institute for Development Studies (2019).

Strand Taken by the SHS-TVL Graduates

The strand taken by the Senior High School – Technical Vocational Graduates from 2018 - 2024 were surveyed to answer the second research question. The frequency count and percentage were presented in the figures below.

Figure 6 shows the strand taken of the SHS-TVL graduates. Data present that graduates from 2018 to 2024, among the four strands of the TVL track offered in Lambayong National High School, 393 (39.20%) graduates took Information and Communication Technology (ICT) strand, 313 (31.20%) took Home Economics strand, 187 (18.70%) graduated with Industrial Arts – Automotive Servicing, and 109 (10.90%) were graduate of Industrial Arts – Electronics and Product Assembly Servicing.

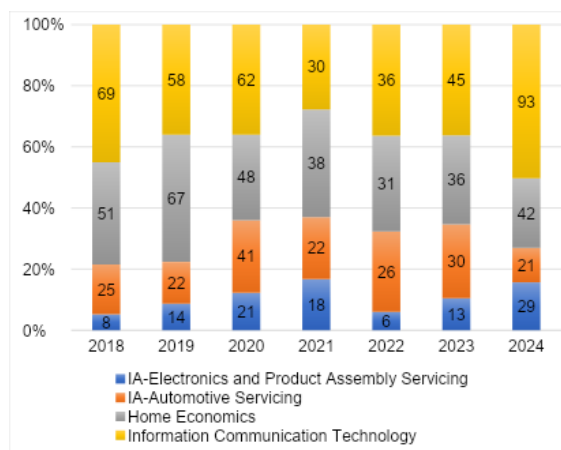


Figure 6. Strand taken by the SHS-TVL Graduates

Statehood of the SHS-TVL Graduates in terms of Higher Education, Employment, Entrepreneurship, Middle Skill Development and Unemployment

The statehood of the senior high school by the Senior High School – Technical Vocational graduates from 2018 - 2024 particular to their higher education, employment, entrepreneurship, middle skill development and unemployment were gathered and analyzed to answer the third research question. The figures present the frequency count and percentage of each statehood.

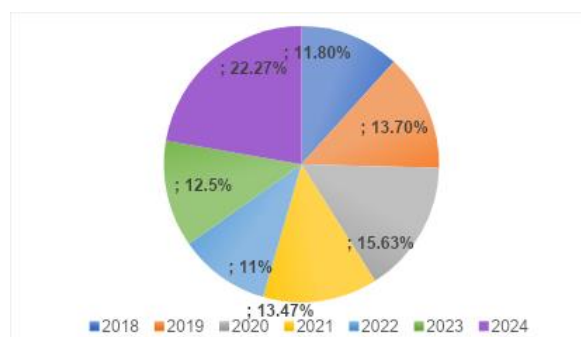


Figure 7. *Frequency and Percentage Distribution of the Statehood of the SHS-TVL Graduates who Pursued Higher Education*

Figure 7 illustrates the frequency and percentage distribution of the statehood of the SHS-TVL graduates who pursued higher education. From the 1002 graduates surveyed, there were 512 (51%) have pursued higher education after senior high school.

Batch 2024 has the highest frequency and percentage of 114 (22.27%) who continued higher education while batch 2018 has the lowest frequency and percentage of 60 (11.80%).

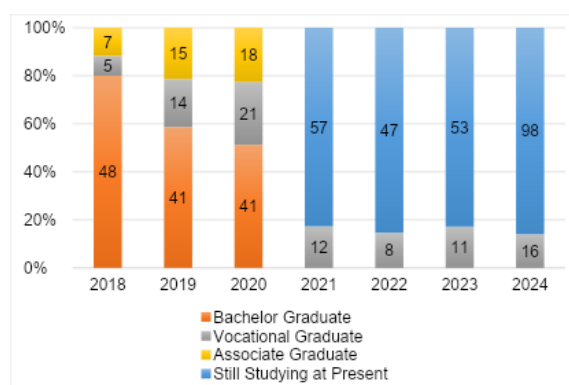


Figure 8. *Frequency and Percentage Distribution of the Statehood of the SHS-TVL Graduates in terms of Higher Education*

Figure 8 shows the frequency and percentage distribution of the statehood of the SHS-TVL graduates in terms of higher education. The figure reveals that many of the graduates of 2018 to 2020 finished bachelor courses with the frequency and percentage of 48 (9.40%), 41 (8.00%), and 41 (7.81%), respectively.

Whereas, many of the graduates of batch 2021 to 2024 still studying at present with the frequency and percentage of 57 (11.13%), 47 (9.18%), 53 (10.35%), and 98 (19.14%), correspondingly.

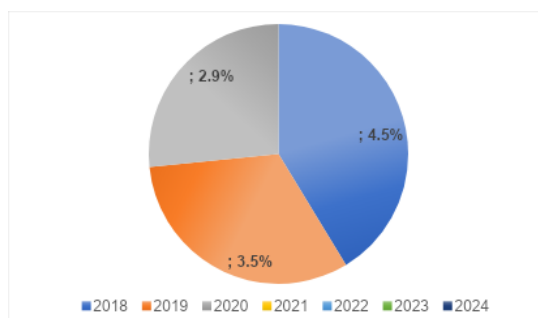


Figure 9. *Frequency and Percentage Distribution of the Statehood of the SHS-TVL Graduates in terms Employment*

Figure 9 demonstrates the frequency and percentage distribution of the statehood of the SHS-TVL graduates pertaining to employment. It can be gleaned from the figure that only three batches were into employment which required bachelor's degree. From the 1002 graduates surveyed, there were 109 (10.9%) have statehood of employment, to wit: 45 (4.5%) from batch 2018, 35 (3.5%) from batch 2019, and 29 (2.9%) from batch 2020.

There are no employed in jobs with bachelor's degree from batches 2021 to 2024 since majority are still studying and some were into middle-skill job. There is a small percentage of graduates were into employment as many fresh graduates entered the labor force but struggled to secure jobs in this period (PSA Intelligence, 2024). Comparable to Padios et al (2021) that the current study's locality is a rural area where employment prospect is less than the urbanized region.

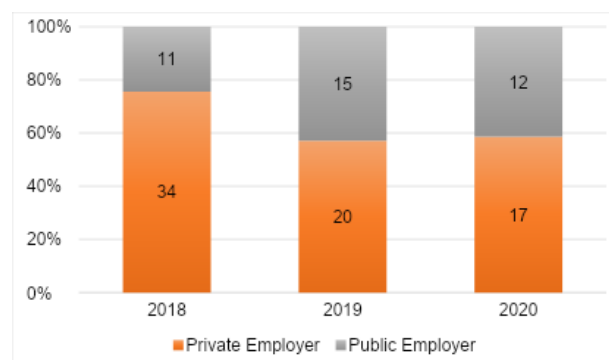


Figure 10. *Frequency and Percentage Distribution of the Statehood of the SHS-TVL Graduates in terms of Employment specific to Agency of Employment*

Figure 10 illustrates the frequency and percentage distribution of the statehood of the SHS-TVL graduates in terms of employment concerning agency of employment. The results show that the majority of the graduates of 2018 to 2020, 71 (65.14%) were employed to private employer whereas 38 (34.86%) were employed by public employer. The result is almost similar with the findings of Febrer et al (2022) 66% of the senior high school graduates were hired by private companies.

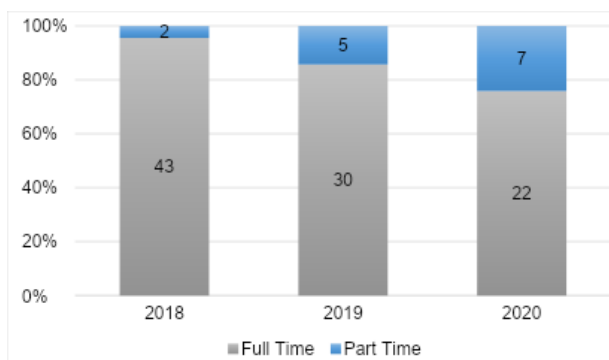


Figure 11. *Frequency and Percentage Distribution of the Statehood of the SHS-TVL Graduates in terms of Employment specific to Status of Employment*

Figure 11 presents the frequency and percentage distribution of the statehood of the SHS-TVL graduates regarding status of employment. Finding reveals that most of the graduates of 2018 to 2020, 95 (87.16%), were working full time while only 14 (12.84%) are working part time.

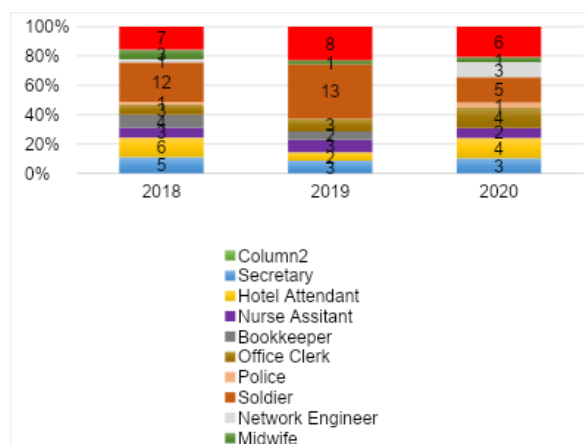


Figure 12. *Frequency and Percentage Distribution of the Statehood of the SHS-TVL Graduates in terms of Employment specific to occupation*

Figure 12 shows the frequency and percentage distribution of the statehood of the SHS-TVL graduates in terms of employment specific to their occupation. Data revealed that in batch 2018 and 2019, the highest frequency and percentage of 12 (26.67%) and 13 (37.14%) are soldier, while the highest frequency and percentage of 6 (20.69%) in batch 2020 was teacher.

Overall, across the three batches, 30 (27.53%) were soldier contrary to the occupation as police which has the lowest frequency and percentage 2(1.83%).

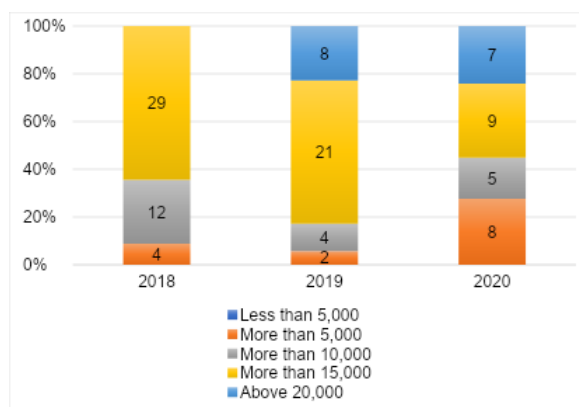


Figure 13. *Frequency and Percentage Distribution of the Statehood of the SHS-TVL Graduates in terms of Employment specific to Monthly Income*

Figure 13 illustrates the frequency and percentage distribution of the statehood of the SHS-TVL graduates focusing with monthly income. The result indicates that graduates of batch 2018 – 2020, 59 (54.13%) of them have monthly income of more than 15,000 while only 14 (12.84%) have monthly income of more than 5,000.

This result indicates that SHS-TVL graduates who were employed belongs to low income (but not poor) according to the Philippine Institute for Development Studies (2019).

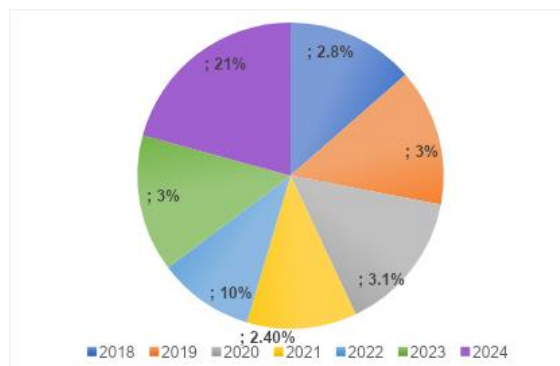


Figure 14. *Frequency and Percentage Distribution of the Statehood of the SHS-TVL Graduates in terms Middle Skill Development*

Figure 14 presents the frequency and percentage distribution of the statehood of the SHS-TVL graduates in terms of middle skill development. From the 1002 graduates' responses, there were 207 (20.7%) are into middle skill development after senior high school. Batch 2024 has the highest frequency and percentage of 43 (21%) while batch 2022 has the lowest frequency and percentage of 21 (10%).

This finding describes that the graduates of batch 2024 who were not able to proceed higher education choose to develop their middle skills by pursuing vocational courses offered by Technical Education and Skills Development Authority (TESDA) and work in middle-skill jobs.

Correspondingly, the result is supported in the findings of Orbeta and Potestad (2020) that workers with middle-level skilled can be hired as grade 12 graduates with Technical-Vocational and Livelihood track and National Certificates Level II and III. Companies considered Senior High School graduates into lower major occupational groups, with most works requiring second or middle-level skills. Some establishments extend entry-level positions with third-skill levels, such as information and communications technology and clinical technicians.

Further, similar to the findings of Choi (2018), discovered that vocational high school graduates have a short-term employment advantage over regular high school graduates, but that advantage diminishes as they get older.

Figure 15 indicates the frequency and percentage distribution of the statehood of the SHS-TVL graduates in terms of middle skill development specific to middle skill job.

Among the middle skill jobs of the graduates, the top three are driver with the frequency and percentage of 43 (20.77%); beautician with the frequency and percentage of 26 (13%); and shop mechanic with the frequency and percentage of 18 (9%) while the lowest was airport station loader with the barely frequency of 1. Considering the locality of the current study, graduates work with middle-skill jobs available in the rural area.

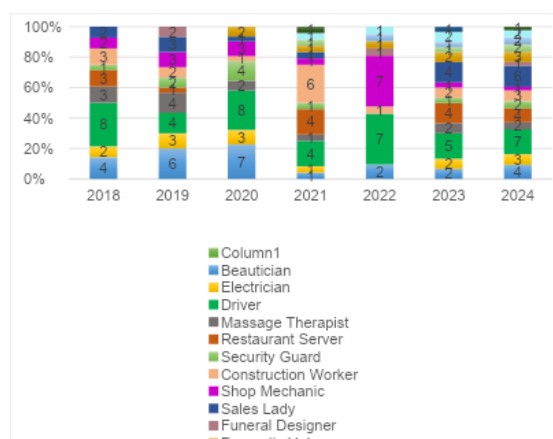


Figure 15. Frequency and Percentage Distribution of the Statehood of the SHS-TVL Graduates in terms of Middle Skill Development specific to Middle-Skill Job

Figure 16 illustrates the frequency and percentage distribution of the statehood of the SHS-TVL graduates focusing on the monthly income. The result indicates that graduates of batch 2018 to 2024, 149 (72%) of them earned monthly income of more than 5,000 while 21 (10.15%) earned monthly income more than 10,000.

This result describes the SHS-TVL graduates who were engaged to middle-skill jobs belongs to poor income according to the Philippine Institute for Development Studies (2019).

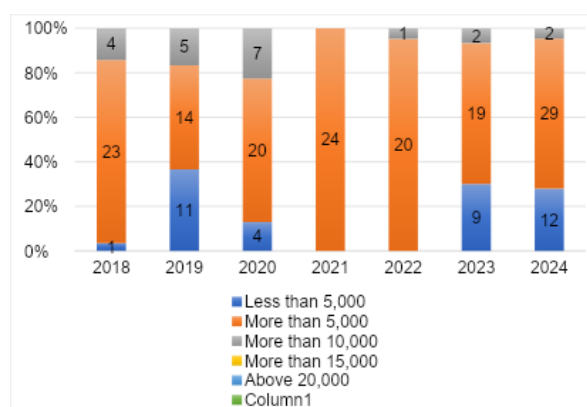


Figure 16. Frequency and Percentage Distribution of the Statehood of the SHS-TVL Graduates in terms of Middle Skill Development specific to Monthly Income

Figure 17 demonstrates the frequency and percentage distribution of the statehood of the SHS-TVL graduates in terms of entrepreneurship. From the 1002 graduates surveyed, there were 44 (4.4%) have statehood of entrepreneurship.

Batch 2018 has the highest frequency and percentage of 9(21%) of entrepreneurship while batches 2021 and 2024 obtained the lowest frequency and percentage of 3 (6.18%). This indicates that there is a few of the SHS-TVL graduates who ventured to business.

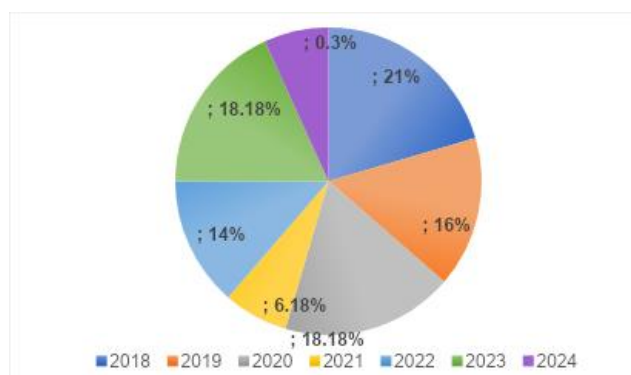


Figure 17. Frequency and Percentage Distribution of the Statehood of the SHS-TVL Graduates in terms Entrepreneurship

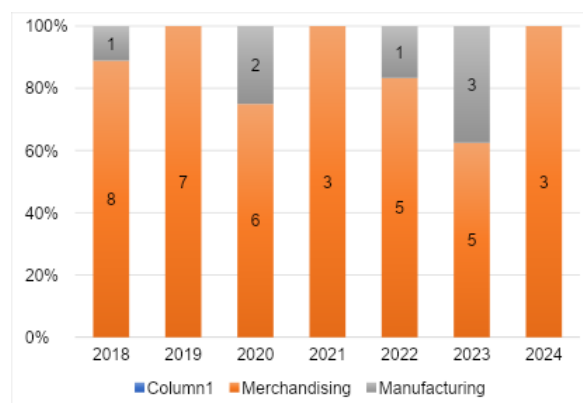


Figure 18. *Frequency and Percentage Distribution of the Statehood of the SHS-TVL Graduates in terms Entrepreneurship Specific to type of Entrepreneurship*

Figure 18 shows the frequency and percentage distribution of the statehood of the SHS-TVL graduates in terms of entrepreneurship specific to the type of entrepreneurship. The data revealed that majority of the graduates who undertake in entrepreneurship particular in merchandising with frequency and percentage of 37 (84.1%) whereas only 7 (16%) were into manufacturing.

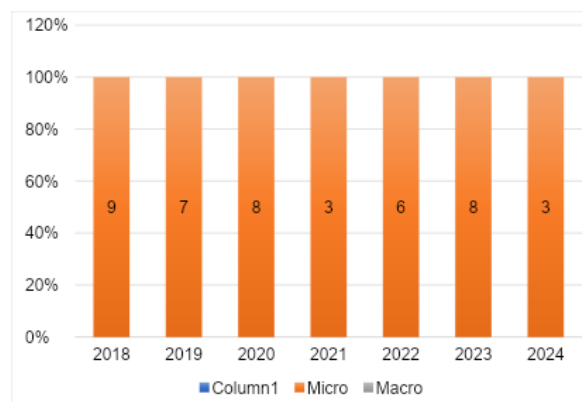


Figure 19. *Frequency and Percentage Distribution of the Statehood of the SHS-TVL Graduates in terms Entrepreneurship Specific to Scale of Entrepreneurship*

Figure 19 shows the frequency and percentage distribution of the statehood of the SHS-TVL graduates in terms of entrepreneurship specific to the scale of entrepreneurship. Result shows that all of the graduates of 2018 to 2024 are into micro entrepreneurship having the frequency and percentage of 44 (100%). This means that SHS-TVL graduates only establish small business similar to Padios et al (2021).

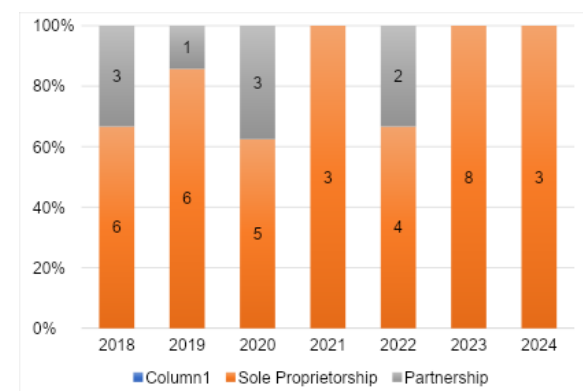


Figure 20. *Frequency and Percentage Distribution of the Statehood of the SHS-TVL Graduates in terms Entrepreneurship Specific to Ownership*

Figure 20 shows the frequency and percentage distribution of the statehood of the SHS-TVL graduates in terms of entrepreneurship specific to ownership. Data reveals that most of the graduates of 2018 to 2024 have sole proprietorship having the frequency and percentage of 35 (80%) while 9 (20%) were into partnership.

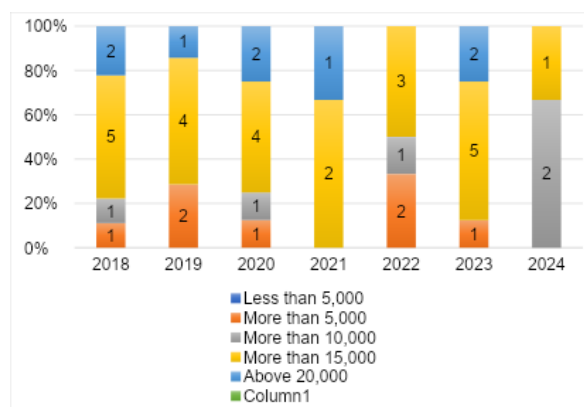


Figure 21. *Frequency and Percentage Distribution of the Statehood of the SHS-TVL Graduates in terms of Entrepreneurship specific to Monthly Income*

Figure 21 presents the frequency and percentage distribution of the statehood of the SHS-TVL graduates in terms of Entrepreneurship specific to monthly income. Data indicates that across the seven batches, 24 (55%) graduates earned monthly income of more than 15,000 in venturing entrepreneurship while 5 (11.40%) earned monthly income more than 10,000. This result shows that the SHS-TVL graduates who are into business belongs to low income (but not poor) class according to the Philippine Institute for Development Studies (2019) and opposed to the findings of Padios et al (2021) that enterprising SHS graduates belong to the low-income class.

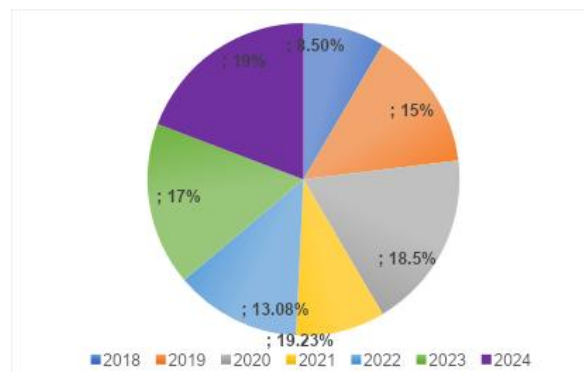


Figure 22. *Frequency and Percentage Distribution of the Statehood of the SHS-TVL Graduates in terms Unemployment*

Figure 22 demonstrates the frequency and percentage distribution of the statehood of the SHS-TVL graduates pertaining to unemployment. The figure shows there are 130 (13%) graduates from 2018 to 2024 were unemployed. Moreover, batch 2024 graduates have the highest frequency and percentage of unemployment 25 (19%) while the lowest frequency and percentage was batch 2018, 11 (8.50%). The result indicates that many of the graduates of batch 2024 are still studying and for that they are not into employment whereas the graduates of 2018 who were able to finish college are now employed.

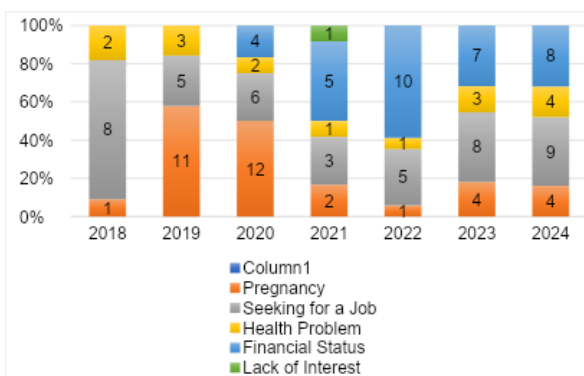


Figure 23. *Frequency and Percentage Distribution of the Statehood of the SHS-TVL Graduates in terms Unemployment specific to Reasons for Unemployment*

Figure 23 shows the frequency and percentage distribution of the statehood of the SHS-TVL graduates pertaining to unemployment focusing on the reason of being unemployed. The results indicate that 44 (33.85%) of the unemployed graduates because of seeking for

a job while there was only 1 (0.80%) who is unemployed because of lack of interest. The respondents who were graduates of college and Senior High School still seek for a job, as a matter of fact the current PSA report that the number of unemployed Filipinos increased in July as millions of young individuals, who graduated from college or senior high school and entered the labor force, did not land jobs during the period (Cordero, 2024).

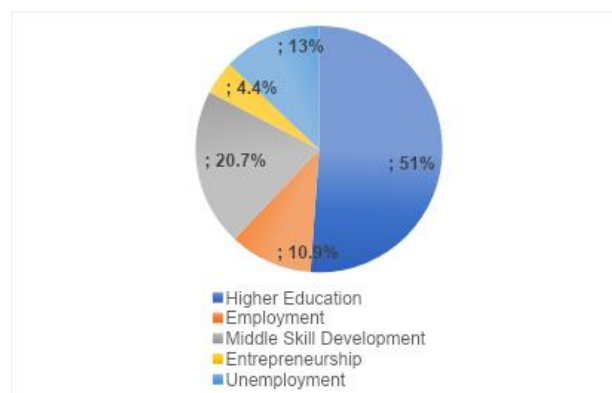


Figure 24. Summary of the Statehood of the SHS-TVL Graduates

Figure 24 shows the summary of the statehood of the SHS-TVL graduates. Out of the 1002 graduates who responded to the survey, half of them pursued in higher education which 512 (51%) which is almost similar to the finding of Febrer et al (2022) which is 57% and lesser than the results of Marces et al, (2020) and Padios et al. (2021) having 84% and 90.82%, respectively. This relatively percentage may be connected to the Filipino conviction that education determines better employment status and, consequently, quality of life (Bacaling, 2019).

Graduates who sought employment was 109 (10.9)% which is greater than Padios et al. (2021) having 4.02% only and lesser than Marces et al, (2020) and Febrer et al (2022) obtaining 15% and 33%, correspondingly. These results revealed that there is a small percentage of graduates were into employment as many fresh graduates entered the labor force but struggled to secure jobs in this period (PSA Intelligence, 2024). Comparable to Padios et al (2021) that the current study's locality is a rural area where employment prospect is less than the urbanized region.

On the other hand, graduates who chose the middle skill development gained 207 (20.7%) which differs from the findings of Marces et al, (2020), Febrer et al (2022), Padios et al (2021) and Ligoyligoy et al (2025) that middle skill development taking middle-level skills development is not a popular choice among the respondents and claiming that these two are the least preferred curriculum exits after senior high school (Gido, 2022). The result of the current study delineates that SHS-TVL graduates that were not able to earn college diplomas, pursued associate and vocational courses instead, through which they developed middle skills and engaged themselves with middle-skill jobs.

Meanwhile, there is only 44 or 4.4% ventured into entrepreneurship, this low percentage is parallel with the results with Padios et al. (2021) and Febrer et al (2022) having 1% and 5% whereas Marces et al (2020) and Ligoyligoy et al (2025) found none of the graduates ventured entrepreneurship. These findings contradict the goal of entrepreneurship as a curriculum exit that helps K to 12 graduates in improving their skills relative to developing, organizing, and managing a business venture, and thus making them financially literate (Cabral & Abanto, 2020).

As concluded by Ligoyligoy et al (2025), the absence of entrepreneurship in the senior high school curriculum suggests potential deficiencies in practical application, student motivation, or external support for entrepreneurial initiatives. Future initiatives to emphasize entrepreneurial education and practical business experiences, mentorship programs, and access to start-up resources.

As to the unemployment rate, there are 130 or 13% who were not engage to employment. This result is higher than 4% of Padios et al (2021) and 5% of Febrer et al (2022) but lower than 16% of Ligoyligoy et al (2025). The unemployment rate of the current study is brought about the graduates who still seeking for a job. This is supported with the current PSA report that the number of unemployed Filipinos increased in July as millions of young individuals, who graduated from college or senior high school and entered the labor force, did not land jobs during the period.

Moreover, Mapa, PSA Chief attributed the increase in July to joblessness among the youth—ages 15 to 24—during the period, noting that many of the fresh graduates from college and senior high school were not absorbed by employers (Cordero, 2024).

Percentage of Alignment Between The SHS-TVL Graduates' Chosen Strands and their Statehood

After determining the statehood of the SHS – TVL graduates from 2018 - 2024 particular to their higher education, employment, entrepreneurship, middle skill development and unemployment, the percentage of alignment is computed to answer the fourth research question. The data gathered and calculated were presented through tables.

Table 1. *Alignment of SHS-TVL Strand to their Statehood in the Year 2018*

SHS TVL Strand Year 2018	Total Graduates	Higher Education Pursued Alignment	Employment Alignment	Entrepreneurship	Middle Skill Job Alignment
IA- Electronics Product Assembly & Servicing	8	3 (37.50%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)	4 (50%)
IA-Automotive Servicing NCII	25	6 (24%)	0 (0.00%)	3 (12%)	7 (28%)
Home Economics	51	24 (47.05%)	10 (19.61%)	5 (9.80%)	12 (23.53%)
Information Communication Technology (ICT)	69	19 (27.54%)	17 (24.64%)	0 (0.00%)	2 (2.90%)

Table 1 presents the alignment of SHS-TVL graduates strand to their statehood in the year 2018. Results reveal that Home Economic (HE) is the strand with the highest percentage of alignment in their higher education pursued, and entrepreneurship with the percentage of 47.05% and 9.80%, respectively while Information Communication Technology (ICT) strand graduates have the highest percentage of alignment in employment with the percentage of 24.64%. Also, IA – Automotive Servicing strand has the highest percentage of alignment in middle skill jobs with the percentage of 28%.

Table 2. *Alignment of SHS-TVL Strand to their Statehood in the Year 2019*

SHS TVL Strand Year 2019	Total Graduates	Higher Education Pursued Alignment	Employment Alignment	Entrepreneurship	Middle Skill Job Alignment
IA- Electronics Product Assembly & Servicing	14	4 (28.57%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)	1 (7.14%)
IA-Automotive Servicing NCII	22	7 (31.82%)	2 (9.09%)	3 (13.63%)	5 (22.73%)
Home Economics	67	12 (17.91%)	7 (10%)	3 (4.50%)	2 (3%)
Information Communication Technology (ICT)	58	22 (37.93%)	10 (17.24%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)

Table 2 shows the alignment of SHS-TVL graduates strand to their statehood in the year 2019. The results show that Information Communication Technology (ICT) strand graduates have the highest percentage of alignment in their higher education pursued with the percentage of 37.93%. and employment having the percentage of 17.24%. Also, IA – Automotive Servicing strands was the highest alignment in their middle skill jobs and entrepreneurship with a percentage of 22.73% and 13.63%, correspondingly.

Strands obtained 0% alignment in their occupation and middle skill jobs are IA – Electronics Products and Assembly Servicing (EPAS) and Information Communication Technology (ICT), correspondingly.

Table 3. *Alignment of SHS-TVL Strand to their Statehood in the Year 2020*

SHS TVL Strand Year 2020	Total Graduates	Higher Education Pursued Alignment	Employment Alignment	Entrepreneurship	Middle Skill Job Alignment
IA- Electronics Product Assembly & Servicing	21	8 (38.10%)	1 (4.76%)	0 (0.00%)	3 (14.29%)
IA-Automotive Servicing NCII	41	7 (17.07%)	2 (4.90%)	2 (4.90%)	7 (17.07%)
Home Economics	48	23 (48.92%)	9 (18.75%)	4 (8.33%)	11 (23%)
Information Communication Technology (ICT)	62	24 (38.71%)	15 (24.19%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)

Table 3 indicates the alignment of SHS-TVL graduates strand to their statehood in the year 2020. Data presents that Home Economic (HE) is the strand with the highest percentage of alignment in their higher education pursued, entrepreneurship and middle skill job with the percentage of 48.92%, 8.33% and 23%, respectively.

Information Communication Technology (ICT) strand graduates have the highest percentage of alignment in their employment having the percentage of 24.19%. Whereas IA – Electronics Products and Assembly Servicing (EPAS) and Information Communication Technology (ICT) strands have 0% alignment in their entrepreneurship and middle skill job.

Table 4 reveals the alignment of SHS-TVL graduates strand to their statehood in the year 2021. The result indicates that Information Communication Technology (ICT) strand graduates have the highest percentage of alignment in their higher education pursued with the percentage of 60%.

While IA – Automotive Servicing is the strand with the highest percentage of alignment in their entrepreneurship and middle skill jobs percentage of 9.09% and 27.27%. On the other hand, all four strands have 0% alignment in their employment.

Table 4. *Alignment of SHS-TVL Strand to their Statehood in the Year 2021*

SHS TVL Strand Year 2021	Total Graduates	Higher Education Pursued Alignment	Employment Alignment	Entrepreneurship	Middle Skill Job Alignment
IA- Electronics Product Assembly & Servicing	18	7 (38.89%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)	2 (11.11%)
IA-Automotive Servicing NCII	22	5 (22.73%)	0 (0.00%)	2 (9.09%)	6 (27.27%)
Home Economics	38	12 (31.60%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)	9 (23.68%)
Information Communication Technology (ICT)	30	18 (60%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)	3 (10%)

Table 5 demonstrates the alignment of SHS-TVL graduates strand to their statehood in the year 2022. The table reveals that Information Communication Technology (ICT) strand graduates have the highest percentage of alignment in their higher education pursued with the percentage of 58.33% while IA – Electronics Products and Assembly Servicing (EPAS) has the highest percentage of alignment in terms of their middle skill jobs with 50.00%.

Table 5. *Alignment of SHS-TVL Strand to their Statehood in the Year 2022*

SHS TVL Strand Year 2022	Total Graduates	Higher Education Pursued Alignment	Employment Alignment	Entrepreneurship	Middle Skill Job Alignment
IA- Electronics Product Assembly & Servicing	6	1 (16.67%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)	3 (50%)
IA-Automotive Servicing NCII	26	11 (42.30%)	0 (0.00%)	1 (3.85%)	6 (23.08%)
Home Economics	31	15 (48.40%)	0 (0.00%)	2 (6.45%)	7 (22.58%)
Information Communication Technology (ICT)	36	21 (58.33%)	0 (0.00%)	1 (2.78%)	2 (5.55%)

Additionally, Home Economic (HE) is the strand with the highest percentage of alignment in their entrepreneurship with the percentage of 6.45%, Under other circumstances, IA – Electronics Products and Assembly Servicing (EPAS) has 0.00% alignment across the three statehoods of the graduates in the year 2022. Moreover, all four strands have 0% alignment in their employment.

Table 6. *Alignment of SHS-TVL Strand to their Statehood in the Year 2023*

SHS TVL Strand Year 2023	Total Graduates	Higher Education Pursued Alignment	Employment Alignment	Entrepreneurship	Middle Skill Job Alignment
IA- Electronics Product Assembly & Servicing	13	5 (38.46%)	0 (0.00%)	1 (7.69%)	6 (46.15%)
IA-Automotive Servicing NCII	30	7 (23.33%)	0 (0.00%)	2 (6.67%)	4 (13.33%)
Home Economics	36	13 (36.11%)	0 (0.00%)	3 (8.33%)	11 (30.56%)
Information Communication Technology (ICT)	45	16 (35.56%)	0 (0.00%)	1 (2.22%)	3 (6.67%)

Table 6 indicates the alignment of SHS-TVL graduates strand to their statehood in the year 2023. The results show that IA – Electronics Products and Assembly Servicing (EPAS) has the highest percentage of alignment in their higher education pursued which is 38.46% and also in middle skill jobs with the percentage of 46.15%. While Home Economic (HE) have the highest percentage of alignment in entrepreneurship is 30.56%. Nevertheless, all four strands have 0% alignment in their employment.

Table 7. *Alignment of SHS-TVL Strand to their Statehood in the Year 2024*

SHS TVL Strand Year 2024	Total Graduates	Higher Education Pursued Alignment	Employment Alignment	Entrepreneurship	Middle Skill Job Alignment
IA- Electronics Product Assembly & Servicing	29	8 (28%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)	7 (24.14%)
IA-Automotive Servicing NCII	21	11 (52.38%)	0 (0.00%)	2 (9.52%)	4 (19.04%)
Home Economics	42	14 (33.33%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)	14 (33.33%)
Information Communication Technology (ICT)	93	28 (30.10%)	0 (0.00%)	0 (0.00%)	12 (13%)

Table 7 presents the alignment of SHS-TVL graduates strand to their statehood in the year 2024. Findings show that Home Economic (HE) strand graduates in middle skill job with equal percentage of 33.33% while IA – Automotive Servicing has the highest percentage of alignment in terms of higher education pursued which is 52.38% and in entrepreneurship having a percentage of 9.52%. In comparison, all four strands have 0% alignment in their employment

Table 8. *Summary Alignment Percentage of SHS-TVL Graduates to their Statehood in the year 2018 - 2024*

Statehood	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	Overall
Higher Education Pursued	87%	64%	81%	46%	87%	64%	54%	67%
Employment	60%	54%	86%	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	67%
Middle Skill Job	89%	27%	68%	83%	86%	80%	86%	74%
Entrepreneurship	89%	86%	75%	67%	67%	88%	67%	80%

Table 8 shows the summary alignment percentage of SHS-TVL graduates strand to their statehood across the year 2018 - 2024. Results reveals that the batches 2018 and 2022 have the highest alignment percentage in their higher education pursued with similar percentage of 87% contrary to the batch 2021 having the lowest alignment percentage of 46%. As to the employment alignment to the graduates' strand, graduates of the year 2020 is the highest with 86% while batch 2019 has the lowest alignment with percentage of 54%. With regards to the middle skill job, 2018 graduates have the highest alignment percentage to their strand taken with 89% and the lowest alignment percentage is the year 2019 having 27%. In terms with the alignment of those who involved with entrepreneurship to the strand taken, batch 2018 was the highest with alignment percentage of 89%.

Overall, the finding exposes that 67% of the SHS-TVL graduates pursued higher education and took courses aligned to their taken strand, thus, implying that the SHS-TVL graduates of Lambayong National High School pursued higher education related to their strand taken, continuing their content, performance and skills acquired during their senior high school in their higher education for further improvement. The result is somewhat similar to the tracer study of Febrer et al (2022) having 65% and less than the findings of the study by Santos et al. (2019), which obtained an 80% alignment rate while it is higher than the alignment percentage of Padios et al. (2021) which was 50% for the same statehood.

This underscores the crucial role of a school providing students varied educational preferences and assistance in discovering their future career whatever their Senior High School specialization in order for them to warrant well-versed decisions on their future ventures. Further substantiated by Okiror et al. (2021) stressing the necessity of making sure that SHS programs give students the information and abilities they need to succeed in their chosen degree programs is highlighted by the fact that misalignment between high school curricula and higher education programs can cause problems with student retention and achievement.

On the other hand, the alignment percentage of the SHS-TVL graduates taken strand who sought employment obtained 67% suggesting that these graduates have sought employment which they can apply the competencies and skills gained from their senior high school – technical vocational livelihood strands and their diploma in college degree. This finding is greater than the findings of Ligoyligoy, et al (2025) having 45% of graduates sought employment and lesser than the finding of Febrer et al (2022) having 80% alignment. In contrary, the studies of Marces et al, (2020) and Padios et al. (2021) revealing that the misalignment rate of the graduates taken strand and their employment were 80.36 % and 81%, respectively.

The alignment percentage result emphasizes that employment as one of the curriculum exits as rationale of the K to 12 program of the Department of Education especially the TVL track implemented in Lambayong National High school was partially achieved. However, the misalignment indicates that some graduates obtain employment outside their learned skills. As supported by Anderson (2020) stressing that the setbacks concerning the alignment of occupational training with labor market demand. Solving this concern compels intensifying industry connections, improving curriculum material, and expanding career guidance assistances to ensure skills correspond with employment possibilities (Ligoyligoy et al.,2025)

Additionally, the alignment percentage of the SHS-TVL graduates taken strand who were engaged in middle skill jobs gained 74% signifying that the TVL graduates have applied their middle skill acquired in their technical middle-level skills training during senior high school and vocational courses. This result is in contradiction to the findings of previous studies of Marces et al, (2020), Padios et al. (2021), Febrer et al (2022), and Ligoyligoy, et al (2025) revealing that middle skill development and jobs were least prioritized by senior high school graduates.

This finding highlights the goal of the K to 12 curriculum offering Technical Vocational Livelihood Track offering technical vocational education, that is to prepare graduates learned skills and knowledge required them to engage to middle-level employment after graduation. As Brillantes et al (2019) described that TVL track as facet of the Senior High School program practices students to acquisition of comprehensible skills/competencies and values resulting into economic benefits. This track plans in providing students with technical vocational training and skills and academic process to prepare them for the needs of the community and the global workplace by training them with competent teachers (Ramos, 2021).

Lastly, entrepreneurship obtained 80% alignment and was the highest among the four curriculum exits and statehoods. This denotes that the SHS-TVL graduates who ventured in entrepreneurship continued their interest and specialization through establishing business

related to their taken strand. This alignment percentage result is closely similar to Padios et al. (2021) having 83.13% alignment with entrepreneurship and greater than of the findings of Febrer et al (2022) with 60% alignment. However, this opposed to Marces et al, (2020) and Ligoyligoy, et al (2025) findings that none of the graduates participated in entrepreneurship and was least preferred.

This finding on entrepreneurship accentuates that with the SHS-TVL graduates specialized skills achieved in their senior high school are applicable not only into employment and middle skill jobs but can also be engaged with business ventures. Chukwuendo et al, (2022) prompt to intensify entrepreneurial education and provide support systems accessible to students pursuing business ventures.

Test of Significant Influence between the Senior High School – Technical Vocational Livelihood graduates’ economic profile and their taken TVL strand

Pearson chi-square test of independence was employed to verify the hypothesis of the study and answer the final research questions if there is a significant influence between the senior high school – technical vocational livelihood graduates’ socio-economic profile and their taken TVL strand.

Table 9. *Pearson Chi-Square Test of Significant Influence of the Graduates’ Socio-Economic Profile and their Taken Strand*

Socio-Economic Profile	Strand				
	Chi-value	Critical value	df	p-value	Interpretation
Age	15.760	7.815	3	.001	Significant
Gender	41.391	7.815	3	.000	Significant
Monthly Family Income	21.082	16.919	9	.012	Significant

* $\alpha = .05$ level of significance

Table 9 indicates the Pearson chi-square test of significant influence of the graduates’ socio-economic profile and their taken strand. Results revealed that the graduates’ age, gender, and monthly family income are predictors on their choice of taking their TVL strands since the computed chi-value of 15.760, 41.391, and 21.082 are greater compared to the chi-critical value of 7.185 and 16.919 with degrees of freedom of 3 and 9, respectively. Hence, the null hypothesis is rejected. Moreover, taking into account that the computed p-value of .001, .000, and .012, are lesser compared to 0.05 level of significance, thus, revealing that the graduates’ socio-economic profile has significant influence to their taken strand.

This finding is opposite to the Febrer et al (2022) age, sex, and monthly family income were not predictors of the graduates taken strand. On the other hand, Nazareno et al. (2020) stressing that socio-demographic factors such as gender, age, and socioeconomic status are among the factors that influence the career track choice. Socio-economic status of the family is one of the key predictors. If financial resources are limited, students tend to choose a career requiring a short education period. Moreover, students with lower family income resort to career decisions requiring minimal investments but resulting in an immediate reward. Similarly, Guevarra (2024) further emphasizes that socio-economic factors also play a critical role in strand selection. Students from privileged backgrounds may lean toward careers in law, medicine, or finance while those from less advantaged backgrounds might choose more accessible career paths. Limited access to education can further restrict career options, particularly for students in low-income areas where resources and opportunities are scarce.

Conclusions

The findings of this study reveal that the socio-economic profile of SHS-TVL graduates generally aligns with the expected educational progression, with most graduates being of the appropriate age, balanced in gender, predominantly single, and from low-income (though not impoverished) households. A shift in educational attainment is observed across batches, with earlier cohorts mostly being college graduates and more recent ones comprising college undergraduates. The majority of graduates pursued strands in Information and Communication Technology (ICT) and Home Economics, while fewer engaged in Industrial Arts. Many graduates continued to higher education, driven by the belief that a college degree enhances employability and quality of life. However, those who did not pursue college tended to engage in middle-skills development through vocational courses, finding employment in related fields. Notably, only a small percentage pursued entrepreneurship, suggesting gaps in practical application or institutional support for business ventures. The alignment between the graduates’ SHS-TVL strands and their chosen post-SHS paths—whether in higher education, employment, or entrepreneurship—indicates that the skills and competencies acquired during senior high school remain relevant and applicable. Furthermore, the study found that age, sex, and family income significantly influence strand selection, with notable gender-based preferences and income-related accessibility considerations. Based on these findings, it is recommended that secondary schools, both public and private, ensure inclusive and equitable access to SHS-TVL programs regardless of demographic background. Schools should also enhance career guidance programs in Grade 10 through stakeholder engagement, industry collaboration, and the effective use of career guidance manuals. Strengthening work immersion partnerships with industries is vital to better prepare students for employment. Policymakers are likewise encouraged to refine SHS curricula to address socio-economic and gender disparities, ensuring that strand selection is guided not only by financial considerations but also by students’ interests and future career trajectories. Additionally, awareness campaigns and policy briefs stemming from this study should be utilized to promote informed decision-making among learners. Future research may explore other influential factors—such as family dynamics, peer influence, individual interests, skills, and geographic proximity—that affect strand and curriculum exit choices to further improve the responsiveness of senior high school

programs to students' diverse contexts.

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